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were trained to use the sarissa, the shorter thrusting spears of the Greek hoplite and even javelins. Alexander used the hypaspists as specialists in difficult situations such as at the rock of Aornos (326BC, see Arrian, *The Campaigns of Alexander*, 4.29–30). Hypaspists probably carried a shield decorated with the royal Macedonian symbol—a five-pointed white or silver star.

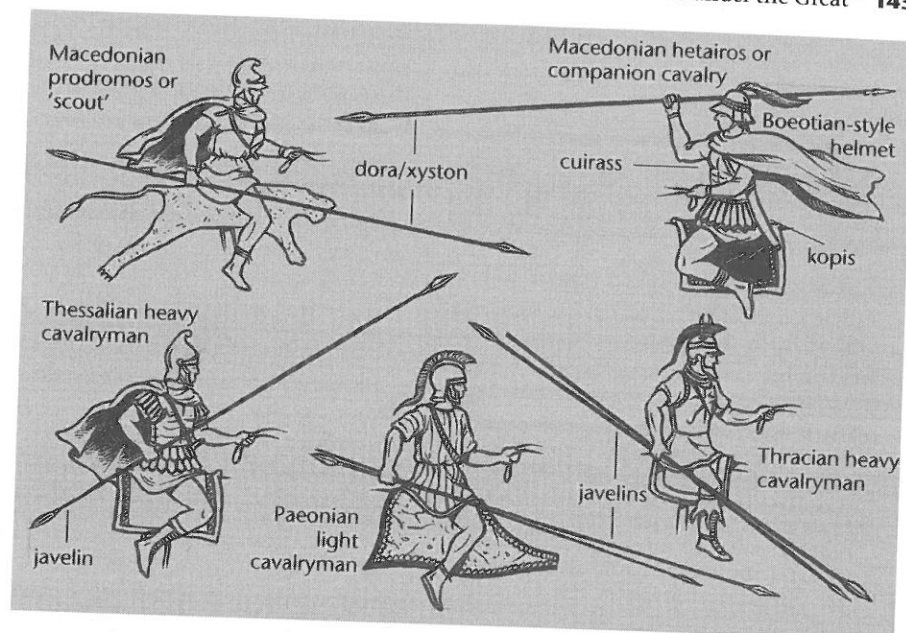
Other infantry

Both Philip and Alexander employed a variety of non-Macedonian infantry. The most famous were the Agrianians, lightly armed specialist javelin men from the lands north of Macedon. Their main weapon was the javelin and they only carried a small shield for protection. They were used together with the Companion cavalry at most of Alexander's battles. Their main job was to harass the enemy, particularly in hilly or wooded terrain, and to provide a screen to protect the pezetairoi from the arrows of opposing archers.

Alexander's army contained allied troops, as could be expected on a joint League mission. These troops were usually hoplites from the various Greek city states or peltasts from places such as Thrace. Hoplites used a long thrusting spear about 2.3 metres long and carried a large shield called a hoplon. They also wore a bronze helmet, a leather or linen cuirass and sometimes greaves to protect their shins. Peltasts wore little body armour. They carried small, light shields and used either javelins or, if they were Thracian, heavy cutting weapons called rhomphaia. Cretan archers and Rhodian slingers also fought. Eventually Alexander also used Persian and other eastern troops in the army.

The cavalry

Alexander's army had a large number of different cavalry types. Most Greek armies had very few cavalry. Philip had realised the importance of these troops for scouting and as a shock weapon during a battle.

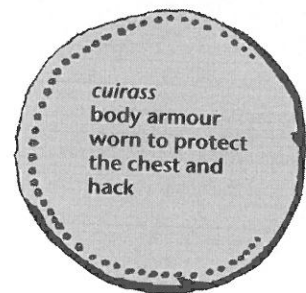


The hetairoi or Companions

The main body of Macedonian cavalry were the Companions or hetairoi. Traditionally these soldiers came from the Macedonian aristocracy, and included Philip and Alexander's most trusted friends. They used the *doru* or *xyston*—a long lance, or spear, approximately 3.6 long—and a sword known as a *kopis*. They wore a bronze helmet of the Boeotian type, a linen or metal cuirass, and leather straps that protected their upper legs while they were fighting. Some wore metal greaves to protect their shins. They could not carry shields as both hands were used, either to control their horses or use their spears while in battle. Archaeological evidence for the equipment of the hetairoi comes from several sources including the so-called Alexander sarcophagus, made for King Abdalonymus of Sidon; the Issus or Alexander mosaic from Pompeii; a monument to a soldier named Alcetas who was killed in Pisidia in 320BC; and a late fourth century BC tomb painting from Egypt.

The hetairoi, unlike conventional cavalry, were able to fight in wedge and rhomboid formations. This allowed them to manoeuvre quickly through small gaps in the enemy's battle line. The hetairoi were highly trained and fought at the battles of

Cavalry types used in Alexander's army



A Boeotian-style helmet